

Board 1

North Deals

None Vul

♠ K 5
 ♥ Q J 9 7 2
 ♦ A Q 6
 ♣ 9 7 3

♠ A J 8 3

♥ 10 6

♦ 7 5 2

♣ A K Q 5



♠ 7 4

♥ A K 4

♦ 10 9 8 4

♣ 10 8 4 2

♠ Q 10 9 6 2

♥ 8 5 3

♦ K J 3

♣ J 6

West

North

East

South

2♥

1♣

Pass

1♠

All Pass

3♠ by South

Lead: ♥Q

♦9 and your side will collect 3 ♦ tricks to go with your 2♥s.

[showcards W:HQ N:H6]

The bidding has been as shown. Partner led the ♥Q, dummy played the ♥6

Overtake with the ♥K.

Your side needs to take 5 tricks to defeat this contract. Two of them will be ♥s, but it doesn't look like you can win any ♣s or ♠s.

That means you need to win 3 ♦ tricks and the only way that can happen is if you play ♦s from your side.

So win the first ♥K (so partner will know you also have the ♥A), and play the ♦10. Presumably South will play an honor, but West will take the trick and put you back on lead with your ♥A. You play the

Board 2

North Deals

None Vul

♠ A K Q 8 6 4

♥ 8

♦ 7 4 2

♣ A J 9

♠ J 3

♥ K Q J 6

♦ A K Q 10 5

♣ 6 2



♠ 10

♥ 7 3 2

♦ 9 8 6 3

♣ Q 7 5 4 3

♠ 9 7 5 2

♥ A 10 9 5 4

♦ J

♣ K 10 8

West

North

East

South

1 ♠

1 ♦

Pass

1 ♥

All Pass

4 ♥ by South

Lead: ♠ A

happen is for you to ruff partner's ♠ K with an otherwise useless trump. You still get your two ♠ winners (sort of) but now you get to play a ♣ through South's ♣ K at trick 3.

[showcards W:SK N:SJ]

The bidding has been as shown. Partner led the ♠ A, then the ♠ K. Dummy follows suit and it is your play to the second trick.

Ruff partner's ♠ K.

It is obvious that your side can only get 2 ♠ tricks. And assuming that South has the Ace of trumps you will not make a single trick in the red suits. So you need to make 2 ♣ tricks.

If partner has the ♣ A K then he will take them, but if he has the ♣ A J he cannot win 2 ♣ tricks from his side.

To allow for this situation it will be better to play ♣s from your side of the table, and the way to make that

Board 3

North Deals

None Vul

♠ 9 7 5 2
 ♥ 8 2
 ♦ 10 7 6 4 3
 ♣ K 7

♠ A 10 4

♥ J 6 3

♦ A K 8 2

♣ Q 10 5



♠ J 8 3

♥ A K 9 7 5

♦ Q 9 5

♣ 6 3

♠ K Q 6

♥ Q 10 4

♦ J

♣ A J 9 8 4 2

West	North	East	South
	1♦	1♥	2♣
Pass	3♣	Pass	3NT
All Pass			

3NT by South

Lead: ♥8
 then try to run the ♣Q.

[showcards W:H8 N:HJ]

The bidding has been as shown. Partner led the ♥8,
 dummy played the ♥J

Play the ♥9. South played dummy's ♥J to tempt you
 to cover. Don't fall for it.

Partner's lead of a high spot card shows no honors in
 the suit. That added to the fact that South bid
 Notrump after you had mentioned ♥s is pretty good
 evidence that South holds at least ♥Q x x.

To maintain communication with partner your best
 hope is to duck the first ♥, but to signal
 encouragement with the ♥9.

South wins the first trick easily, but must try to
 establish ♣s. He will enter dummy with the ♠A,

Not today. Partner takes the ♣K and returns his ♥2 to your four winners.

Board 4

South Deals

None Vul

♠ K 6 2
 ♥ 10 6 4
 ♦ A J 6 5 4
 ♣ 9 2

♠ Q J 9 3

♥ K Q J 5

♦ 9 3

♣ Q J 10

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♠ 8 4

♥ 9 7 3

♦ 10 8 7 2

♣ A 6 5 3

♠ A 10 7 5

♥ A 8 2

♦ K Q

♣ K 8 7 4

West	North	East	South
			1NT
Pass	2♣	Pass	2♠
Pass	4♠		
All Pass			
4♠ by South			
Lead: ♣9			
distribution.			

[showcards W:C9 N:CT]

The bidding has been as shown. Partner led the ♣9, dummy played the ♣10

Play the ♣6.

Partner's ♣9 is likely from a short suit. If it is a singleton, you should take the ♣A immediately and return the suit for a ruff. If it is a doubleton, you should NOT take your ♣A now, but should hope partner can get the lead and play his second ♣ to your Ace so you can give him the ruff.

You can figure out which it is.

If it is a singleton, then South must hold 5 ♣s. But you know South has 4 ♠s, so if he also has 5 ♣s then he only has 4 red cards, and he would not have opened 1NT with either 5-4-2-2 or 5-4-3-1

So partner's ♣9 is not a singleton, and you should wait. Declarer then runs dummy's ♠Q. Partner wins the ♠K, returns his OTHER ♣ to your ♣A, and NOW you give him the ruff. He takes the ♦A for down 1.

Board 5

East Deals

None Vul

♠ 10 8 3

♥ 10 2

♦ Q J 8 6 4 2

♣ 8 3

♠ 6 5 2

♥ J 9 8

♦ 9 5

♣ K J 10 9 7



♠ Q J 9 7

♥ K Q 6 5 3

♦ 10

♣ A 6 4

♠ A K 4

♥ A 7 4

♦ A K 7 3

♣ Q 5 2

West	North	East	South
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Pass	2♣	1♥	Dbl
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Pass	3NT	Pass	2NT
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All Pass

3NT by South

Lead: ♥10
those two ♣ winners.

[showcards W:HT N:HJ]

The bidding has been as shown. Partner led the ♥10, dummy played the ♥J

Play the ♥6.

Declarer gets two ♥ winners whether you play one of your honors on this trick or not. So why does it matter what you do?

Suppose you cover with your ♥Q. South will win his ♥A, then play ♣s until your ♣A is forced out on the third round. He can then force an entry to dummy in the ♥ suit to reach the two ♣ winners.

Now suppose you duck the ♥J. Again South will push ♣s, and again you hold up until the third round. Ahh, what a difference. Now declarer cannot use the ♥s to enter dummy and he will never get to enjoy